

Perhaps someone will want to use me as an example as well.

You see your career as halfway through, but if it were to end tomorrow, what would you be most proud of?

I think I'd be most proud of the fact that I was authentically myself. It's also only recently that I've been able to get to the point where I've been able to see the people whom I've inspired. I now have a new generation coming in and saying, 'Hey, I watched you, and you inspired me to run.' These are my first few years of hearing that, and it's very surreal. I never started my journey thinking I wanted to inspire people. I simply wanted to be the best and reach something nobody had reached. Along the way, I looked back and saw people following the path I was on. Now I think, 'Wow, I need to make better routes. I need to make sure the paths they're taking are safe and that they don't go through all the same struggles I did.'

One of the challenges you've faced is that it's not enough to be good on the track. Carl Lewis says the challenge for athletes today is

balancing that with social media and commitments.

See, the thing is, I love running, but I also want to leave the sport in a better position than I found it. It's always interesting to see athletes become world champions for the first time. You can always tell what kind of world champion they're going to be by how they handle the first few days after winning the title.

As soon as you become world champion, the next day you're going to your sponsors' house, and you have to do media for three or four hours. You're up early signing autographs. That's what a world champion has to do.

When you see the energy they put into that, you get an idea of what kind of world champion they're going to be. Is this going to be somebody who will constantly try to push the envelope, or someone who might fold or crack under the pressure because so much is demanded of them?

I think we have to prepare athletes for more. It's not just about winning on the track; it's about being an inspiration. It's about carrying that mantle, no matter how heavy it gets.



What's the first app you have open when you get up in the morning?

Probably *Tiktok* or *Instagram*.

What's your favourite Indian meal?

Butter chicken. Of course, there will be sides with it. But yeah, that's the part that I care about the most.

What's a rule you would like to change in World Athletics?

There are a whole lot of rules to change. We need to change the sponsorship rule and allow multiple sponsors to get involved, especially on jerseys and bibs, though I think that's more of a shoe sponsor issue than a World Athletics one.

One thing we really need to do is start getting into many more spaces where we currently aren't. I also don't know if it's even a rule, but simply changing the place where jumpers take off from isn't going to help with anything.

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